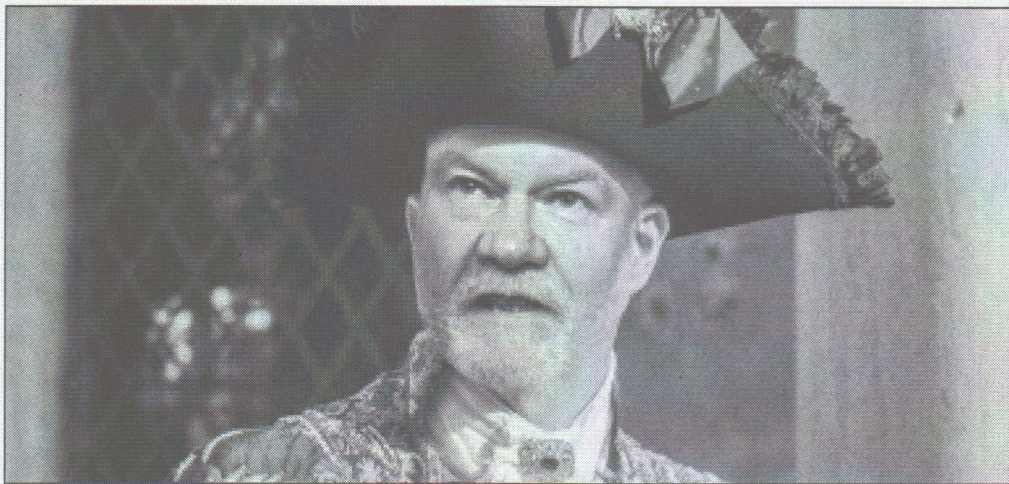


KREWE OF VERSAILLES DISBANDED; OVER 100 YEARS OF PARADES DISCARDED



Cyril Fortier, captain of the recently disbanded Krewe of Versailles.

By Ella Montgomery, Ergeaux Staff

The Krewe of Versailles was formally dissolved yesterday evening after a tense dialogue between krewe members and the city council. The reason for the disbanding has not yet been released.

As many NOLA residents know, the Krewe of Versailles is one of the most cherished old-line krewes. Their influence on Mardi Gras and New Orleans has grown exponentially since their small start in the late 19th century.

On the evening of June 17, 1884, James L. Hebert, Louis R. Reed, John A. Fontenot, Charles E. Fortier and Michael J. Richard gathered in the parish hall of their local church to discuss the possibility of a Carnival krewe. There, the five chose the theme of opulence and the name Versailles, inspired by the French palace of lavish repute.

Despite their fair share of controversies, such as when the krewe laid claim to the route of the Krewe of Patroclus in 2004, the Krewe of Versailles has remained an ever-present Carnival fixture. Current captain Cyril Fortier, CEO of Fortier Foods, has mentored several novice captains over the years, including Krewe d'Ulysse's Jeremy Bacon and Mystic Krewe of Marie Laveau's Celestine Broussard, helping their fledgling krewes navigate Carnival politics and traditions.

This is the first time since its inception that the Krewe of Versailles has not been allowed to run. While Fortier has remained silent on yesterday's events, folks around town have had plenty to say when it comes to the decision to disband the krewe.

Sasha Temple, a tattoo artist at Ink Your Bones, posted on Birdlr, "I'm glad [the Krewe of Versailles] are gone... turn the page."

Breezy Bellweather, makeup artist and hostess at one of Fortier's chicken restaurants, contacted the Ergeaux offices directly to dismiss the events as "a witch hunt; total nonsense."

Another person (who insisted on remaining anonymous) reported their theories on the sudden decision for the krewe: "I'm not suggesting anything, but I'm sure they were sabotaged. Probably some rival krewe trying to dig up something where there isn't anything. I just don't believe the city would or even could ban them otherwise."

Regardless of why the krewe won't be running, what everyone really wants to know is who's going to take their place and become the next big hit of the season?

Open Palm Tarot Readings

Dig deep into your inner psyche and find the
answers you've been looking for!
Get a free one-use coupon on your first visit!

